

“All the News
That’s Fit to Print”

The New York Times

THE WEATHER
Today, sunny, hot and humid, high 90. **Tonight**, a clear sky, light winds, low 74. **Tomorrow**, hazy sunshine and still very warm, light winds, high 89. Weather map, Page 20.

VOL. CLXXV . . . No. 60,971

© 2026 The New York Times Company

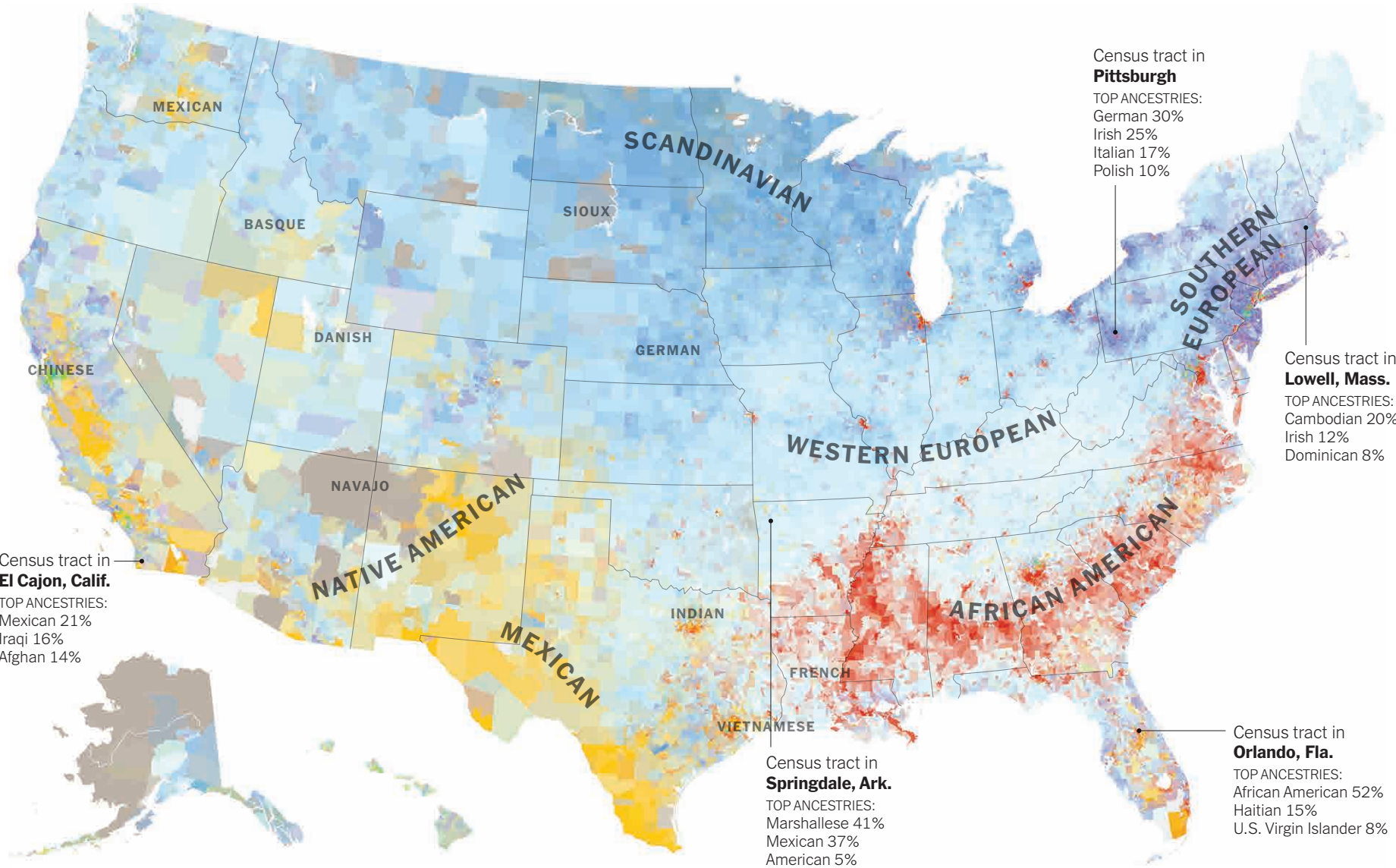
SUNDAY, AUGUST 9, 2026

Prices in Canada may be higher

\$6.00

Tracing the Roots of a Nation of Immigrants

Melting pot, tapestry, mosaic, kaleidoscope. Detailed maps based on census data show how America came to be all these things. A SPECIAL REPORT, PAGES 15-18.



Inside a Drive To Stop Funds For Hezbollah

This article is by Euan Ward, Eric Schmitt, Ronen Bergman and Hwaida Saad.

BEIRUT, Lebanon — When Israel launched its latest war against Hezbollah in March, the first targets the military warned it would strike were not weapons depots or underground command centers.

They were banks. Israeli fighter jets leveled more than a dozen branches of a shadowy financial institution known as Al-Qard al-Hassan, long accused of operating as Hezbollah’s bank in Lebanon. More airstrikes followed on exchange shops that Iran used to funnel money to Hezbollah, its Lebanese proxy, and on gas stations that generated revenue for the group.

With these strikes, Israel was sending a clear message: Hezbollah’s money, not only its arsenal, was in the cross hairs.

The bombings capped the most aggressive campaign yet by Israel, the Trump administration and Lebanon’s government to squeeze Hezbollah financially by disrupting the group’s funding channels, particularly from Iran.

For months leading up to the war, Lebanon’s government, under pressure from the Trump administration, worked to choke off the routes that the group used to receive and move money, such as Beirut’s international airport. Washington also pressed the Lebanese central bank to tighten controls over the country’s cash economy, which Hezbollah had long exploited.

Now, Hezbollah is grappling with its most severe economic strain in years, according to documents reviewed by The New York Times and interviews with Lebanese, U.S. and Israeli officials and Hezbollah insiders. Most spoke on the condition of anonymity, citing confidential intelligence assessments, diplomatic protocol or fear of retribution.

The war that began in March

Continued on Page 10

How the Reflecting Pool Mirrored Trump’s Administration

This article is by Maxine Joselow, David A. Fahrenthold, Tyler Pager and Clarence Williams.

WASHINGTON — In January, the World of Concrete trade show drew 47,000 people to the Las Vegas Convention Center. One of them was the manager of a Trump Organization golf club in New Jersey, who had come seeking help with an enormous, unfamiliar task.

The manager, David Schutzenhofer, wanted ideas for how to fix the leaking, algae-ridden Lincoln Memorial Reflecting Pool in Washington.

Several vendors told him they knew just the guy to call: Rodney Jarboe, the president of the Missouri-based company Creative Polymers. Mr. Jarboe had worked on a bridge at another federal landmark, the Gateway Arch in St. Louis.

Laws and Facts Skirted, and Blame Passed

In an interview, Mr. Jarboe said he first spoke in March with Mr. Schutzenhofer, who made clear that the work would be rushed. President Trump, Mr. Jarboe said he was told, wanted the renovation project done in time for the

country’s 250th birthday July 4.

“For this thing to be done in the time frame that was required, we almost had to have a contract and start manufacturing by the first week of April,” Mr. Jarboe said. “So it was a very tight deadline to make a decision.”

Those initial conversations about the Reflecting Pool, which have not previously been reported, kicked off an ad hoc plan

Continued on Page 14



LAETITIA VANCON FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Whirling Toward Transcendence

A seven-day retreat in Turkey centered on sema, the ancient spiritual practice of whirling. Page 6.

For More College Graduates, Moving Home Is a No-Brainer

By NOAM SCHEIBER

When he hadn’t landed a job a few months after graduating from the University of California, Santa Cruz, two years ago, Tommy Balmat moved back to his childhood home in the San Francisco Bay Area. He figured looking for a job would be easier with fewer expenses to shoulder. And, perhaps no less important, he was still close with his parents, who were keen to have him back.

“I communicate with my parents about every thought that goes through my head,” said Mr. Balmat, who majored in literature and anthropology and had hoped for a job in book publishing. “They honestly really encouraged me to come back home if that’s what I wanted.”

Mr. Balmat is hardly the only recent graduate to have accepted

such an invitation lately. Data from the economists Stefania Albanesi, Rania Gihleb and Ning Zhang show that the portion of college graduates ages 23 to 27 living with their parents has returned to the high it reached during the Covid-19 pandemic. More than one-quarter did so as of last year, from a low of about 18 percent in 2001, according to updates to the paper that are not yet online.

The fact that so many young adults are living at home reflects persistent weakness in the job market for recent graduates even as the overall economy remains fairly strong. The weakness may be growing as artificial intelligence affects white-collar jobs.

Continued on Page 24

At Kennedy Center, Few Creatures Were Stirring, Not Even ...

By ELIZABETH WILLIAMSON

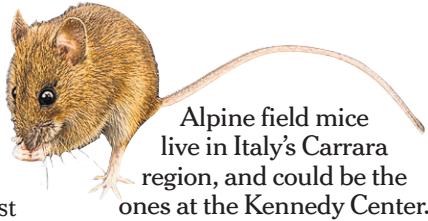
WASHINGTON — President Trump’s takeover of the John F. Kennedy Center for the Performing Arts has left the building nearly empty. So the few lonely staff members who remain ahead of a potential two-year closure this month for renovations are prone to sharing tales of what for 50

years has made the place special. Like the mice.

Kennedy Center mice do not resemble the typical gray house mice found in fields and woods in warmer weather and in kitchens and attics when it’s cold. They are roughly half that size, with large ears and fur of a golden tan color that, if they were horses, would be called palomino. Their bellies are pearl white.

For years stagehands have spotted a tan mouse — or maybe alternating mice — sitting motionless beneath a wheelchair ramp facing one of the center’s two Millennium Stages, seemingly watching the evening shows. Over the holidays in 2024, the mice devoured a fancy charcuterie board that the cast of the Broadway musical “& Juliet” left out overnight in the Opera House.

The mice have also nosed their way into reviews of Kennedy Center performances. In 2018, what The Washington Post called a “baby mouse” lingered in the Concert Hall during a National Symphony Orchestra performance of Tchaikovsky’s “Francesca da Rimini.” The mouse ran for the prime seats near the stage and “scurried



Alpine field mice live in Italy’s Carrara region, and could be the ones at the Kennedy Center.

around 12 or more rows near the left aisle, forcing audience members to move their coats and bags as they struggled to remain quiet and still,” a Post arts reporter,

Continued on Page 13

INTERNATIONAL 4-11

Russians Bomb Gas Stations

Drone attacks have hit nearly 200 fueling spots in Ukraine lately, retaliating for Kyiv’s attacks on refineries. PAGE 4

Removing a 1944 Blockade

Serbia has begun pulling out of the Danube River vessels that the Nazis sunk to block the Soviets. PAGE 8

SUNDAY BUSINESS

The A.I. Avalanche

The number of A.I. computer chips that enable the technology to grow is doubling every nine months. But where will it all lead? PAGE 4



SUNDAY STYLES

Songs for Stressful Times

For many of his fans, Jack Johnson’s unassuming beach pop is the perfect antidote to an era of anxiety. PAGE 4

NATIONAL 12-25

Tacky, Rude and a Landmark

South of the Border in Dillon, S.C., is a throwback to an era of kitschy roadside attractions. Is it worth saving? PAGE 12

A Loyalist at the Justice Dept.

In confirming Todd Blanche, senators backed a champion of unbridled presidential power. News Analysis. PAGE 19

ARTS & LEISURE

Leaping Into Harm’s Way

Veterans of TV and film teach students at a school in Seattle how to get set on fire, jump from high places, perform in fight scenes and more. PAGE 6



REAL ESTATE

Homes Shipped Overseas

Abandoned Japanese folk houses are being dismantled and rebuilt in other countries, in an effort to keep history and heritage alive. PAGE 8

SUNDAY OPINION

Camille Bromley

PAGE 6

METROPOLITAN

Two Perspectives on the City

Reihan Salam, the head of the Manhattan Institute, and Mayor Zohran Mamdani are both convinced that New York is in crisis. For Mr. Salam, the crisis is Mr. Mamdani. PAGE 7

Where Can You Drone On?

Bagpipers need places to practice their music, but in New York City, such spaces are at a premium. We follow some of the players to canals, cemeteries and remote parking lots. PAGE 1

